

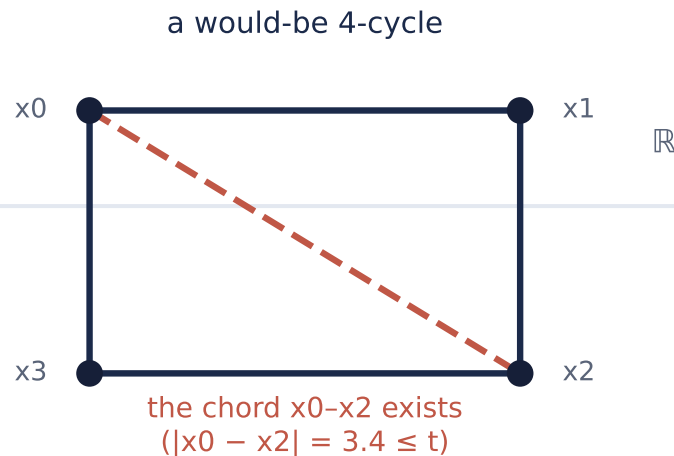
points on a line

⇒ indifference graph

⇒ chordal: every cycle ≥ 4 has a chord

⇒ clique complex is contractible

⇒ **$H_1 = 0$ exactly**



curvature and triangle-filling arguments were tried first — both are wrong; chordality is the reason